

Medical Emergency Checklist — Travel in Italy

Print this checklist and keep it with your passport. Fill out the emergency template near the end and carry a copy in your wallet throughout your trip.

Emergency Numbers to Know

112 GENERAL EMERGENCY Police · Fire · Ambulance (EU-wide, free)	118 AMBULANCE Direct medical / health emergency line	116117 NON-URGENT HELP Medical advice for non-emergencies
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112 is the single European emergency number — free from any phone, no area code needed. The operator routes you to police, fire, or ambulance services and can connect English-speaking help.¹ 118 is Italy's dedicated urgent-medical/ambulance line (still active alongside 112 in most regions).² 116117 is for non-urgent medical questions or advice — not for emergencies, and it cannot be dialed from a locked mobile screen.³

U.S. Embassy Rome — Contact Details

Address	Via Vittorio Veneto 121, 00187 Roma, Italy
Switchboard	+39 06-4674-1 (dial 011-39-06-4674-1 from a U.S. phone)
After-hours emergency	Same number, +39 06-4674-1 — ask for the Duty Officer for a citizen's death, arrest, hospitalization, or injury
U.S. citizen services	Walk-in emergency passport help, Mon–Fri, 8:30 a.m.–12:00 p.m.

Traveling outside Rome? Consulates General in Milan, Florence, and Naples also provide emergency U.S. citizen services — check it.usembassy.gov/u-s-citizen-services/emergency-contact for the number matching your location.⁴

How to Find a Pharmacy (Farmacia)

- 1 Look for the green cross. Every licensed Italian pharmacy displays an illuminated green cross sign — this is the universal signal, distinct from a hospital's red cross. Lit = open; dark = closed.⁵
- 2 Check if it's flashing. Many signs display the current time and temperature on an LED marquee, but a steady or flashing green cross always means the pharmacy is open for business.⁵
- 3 Note the posted rotation schedule. Closed pharmacies post a paper sign in the window listing the nearest "farmacia di turno" (duty pharmacy) that stays open overnight, on Sundays, and holidays on a rotating basis.⁶
- 4 Ask a local for help. Use the phrase "Scusi, dov'è la farmacia più vicina?" ("Excuse me, where is the nearest pharmacy?") — hotel staff, restaurant staff, or shopkeepers will know immediately.⁶
- 5 Talk to the pharmacist first. Italian pharmacists hold a university degree and can assess minor ailments, recommend over-the-counter treatment, and advise whether you need a doctor or emergency room — often without an appointment.⁶
- 6 Use your phone as a backup. Search "farmacia" in Maps, or check your regional health authority (ASL) website, which lists the open/on-duty pharmacy schedule for your area.

Your Emergency Information

Fill this out before you travel. Keep one copy in your wallet and photograph a second copy to store on your phone.

Personal Details

Full name (as on passport)

Date of birth

Blood type (if known)

Allergies

Current medications

Existing medical conditions

Travel Insurance Information

Insurance company name

Policy / member number

24-hour emergency assistance phone (with country code)

Policy start / end date

Pre-existing condition coverage notes

Emergency Contacts

Emergency contact 1 — name, relationship, phone

Emergency contact 2 — name, relationship, phone

Home physician — name, phone

Hotel / accommodation address in Italy

Wallet Card — Cut Along the Dashed Line

Copy your key details onto this card, cut it out, and carry it with your passport or ID every day of your trip.

MEDICAL EMERGENCY CARD — ITALY	
Name	Blood type
Allergies	Conditions
Insurance co. / policy #	
Insurance 24h phone	
Emergency contact 1	
Emergency contact 2	
112 General · 118 Ambulance · 116117 Non-urgent	U.S. Embassy Rome: +39 06-4674-1